



Final days

One thing that Leonardo may not have known about King Francis I, his new patron, was how he became king of France in the first place.



King Francis I

At his birth, Francis had been way down the line of people with a claim to the French throne. But one heir died unexpectedly, another had no children, and existing laws did not allow women with better claims to rule. So when his cousin (and father-in-law) Louis XII died, Francis,

age 21, was next in line to be king.

King Francis was a great supporter of writing and the arts, which began when he invited Leonardo to France. King Francis also